

Selective summary and attitudes

Paper 1 · Question 2 · 20 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

What you will learn

Select only task-relevant ideas, write a coherent 120-word summary and interpret speakers' attitudes.

How this assessment works

All candidates take Paper 1. Centres then enter candidates for Paper 2 or the Coursework Portfolio. Speaking and Listening is optional and separately endorsed. The supplied June 2026 papers inform presentation only; question structure and word limits in this guide follow the 2027-2029 syllabus.

Select and compress

A summary is shaped by its question. Mark each relevant benefit or difficulty, remove repeated examples, group similar points, and use neutral own words. Write continuous prose of no more than 120 words. Do not add your own opinion. The reading content carries 10 marks and concise, accurate writing 5.

Worked example

If the question asks for benefits and difficulties, combine “buttons, clothes, lights” as practical repair skills; do not spend three clauses listing objects.

Interpret an attitude

Attitude is more than a label such as “happy”. Identify what a speaker values or fears, then support it with a detail. Balance mixed positions: a person can support a project while questioning its growth.

Worked example

Ms Hale values the connections made at the table but fears too many sessions would damage its patient atmosphere. That is cautiously supportive, not opposed.

Practice paper

Selective summary and attitudes

All passages and questions in this FagusED practice are original. Write in English. Marks appear in square brackets. Use the lines provided; extra paper may be attached if required.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Quick check · FagusED diagnostic (outside the Cambridge paper)

A brief study check; the official 0500 written papers use structured and extended answers.

What belongs in a neutral summary?

- A A personal recommendation
- B Repeated examples of the same point
- C Distinct relevant ideas in own words
- D An invented statistic

Reading text

At first, the school library's repair table was simply a place to mend damaged books. Volunteers brought tape and glue, and students learned to reinforce loose pages. Soon someone arrived with a torn backpack, and the librarian added needles and thread. The monthly session now takes place after school, when volunteers show visitors how to replace buttons, patch clothing and fix basic bicycle lights.

The benefits extend beyond the objects themselves. Younger students learn practical skills from older volunteers, while people who seldom meet have a reason to talk. A repaired item can stay in use instead of being replaced, reducing waste. The library says its modest equipment budget is covered by donations, although it cannot promise that every repair will work.

There are practical difficulties. Specialist parts may cost more than an old product is worth, and electrical repairs require supervision for safety. Sessions become crowded when a single experienced volunteer is absent. Students preparing for examinations may struggle to attend regularly. To keep the project manageable, the librarian asks visitors to register and describes each session as a chance to learn, not a free repair service.

Volunteer Arun is delighted when a student learns to sew a button without help. He worries, however, that some visitors expect instant results and abandon a repair as soon as it becomes difficult. Librarian Ms Hale is proud of the conversations the table creates, but she resists expanding to every lunchtime. "If we make promises we cannot keep," she says, "we may lose the patient atmosphere that makes it useful."

Questions

2(a) Summarise the benefits of the repair table and the difficulties in running it. Write in continuous prose, using your own words as far as possible. Write no more than 120 words. **[15]**

2(b) Explain the different attitudes of Arun and Ms Hale towards the repair table, supporting each view with evidence. **[5]**

Answers and teacher guidance

Check your response only after finishing the practice. Responses can be expressed in other valid words when their meanings are supported by the source.

2(a) Reading [10]: benefits include useful repair skills, intergenerational learning, social contact, less waste, longer item life, donations covering basic equipment; challenges include costly parts, specialist supervision for electricity, dependence on volunteers, exam schedules, visitor expectations, crowding and the need to register. Writing [5]: concise organisation, own words, clarity and control. Sample (83 words): "The repair table teaches practical skills and brings together people who might not otherwise meet. It extends the life of possessions, reduces waste and is funded partly by donations. However, some parts are uneconomical, electrical work needs supervision, and sessions rely on volunteers whose absence causes crowding. Students may be unable to attend regularly, while some visitors expect an immediate service rather than a learning opportunity. Registration and realistic limits help the library keep the sessions manageable."

2(b) Arun enjoys seeing independent learning, as shown by his delight when a student sews without help [2]; he is frustrated by visitors expecting instant results [1]. Ms Hale values the conversations [1] but fears expansion could destroy the calm, patient setting [1].

Diagnostic answer

1: C

Source for assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE First Language English 0500 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/718783-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages and questions by FagusED; June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user consulted for response layout and feedback style. This is independent study material, not an official Cambridge paper.